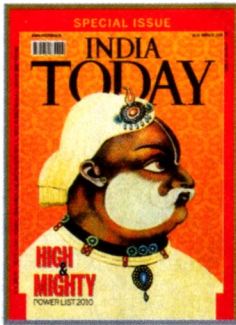


High and Mighty

MARCH 22, 2010

The business class still dominates but new challengers are on the rise.



“These extraordinary people from different walks of life had everything penned out in their dreams to make their destiny. This is indicative of our country’s liberal outlook and support to innovative individuals.”

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Power Play

The Power List 2010, comprising the privileged 50, has virtually all those who are currently wealthy, notwithstanding the fact that the wealth created is out of their professional expertise (“Perched on the Pinnacle”, March 22). Therefore, the power to influence would arguably be derived more through the wealth that they currently possess. One would have loved to find more of social activists like Aruna Roy in such a list as this would reflect on their ability to influence society through the sheer power of their conviction and resolve to spread goodness. **ANJUM M. SAMEL,**
Mumbai

Your official list portrays classic and balanced features of contemporary



Women on Top

It remains to be seen if the Women’s Reservation Bill will actually empower women (“Long Way Home”, March 22). The screech for women’s reservation stalks from an urgent need to assimilate more women in India’s mainstream. The Congress and BJP must set their differences aside and see that the Bill is passed in the Lok Sabha. **VINOD C. DIXIT,**
Ahmedabad

Due credit must be given to the BJP and Left parties without whose cooperation the Women’s Reservation Bill would still be hanging fire. This also affirms that with political will and cooperation of the Opposition, problems faced by the *aam aadmi* can be easily resolved. **K.R. SRINIVASAN,**
Secunderabad

politicians of India (“The Official Top Ten”, March 22). Sonia Gandhi’s is a case of rise-fall-rise of the ‘Mother Superior’. It was exciting to know that she listens more to the NGOs than members of the House. The brief profiles of people, from prime minister to the chief minister of Uttar Pradesh, home minister, senior ministers, economists, bankers and industrialists, are informative for readers.

RAMESH SINHA,
Delhi

Your special issue presenting the lists—50 high and mighty people, official top 10 figures, top 10 advisers and top 20 overseas Indians—show clearly where India is heading. We can be a big global player if we go

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